EDITORIAL:
Krönika

När man jobbar med grafisk design är ett av de viktigaste jobben att arbeta med text till olika sorters tidningar, magasin, böcker, eller broschyrer. I det här projektet får du göra det, och samtidigt hjälpa skolans elever med deras texter.

I mappen "Krönikearkiv" finns texter som elever på RG skrivit i Svenska eller Engelska. Ditt jobb är att välja en av dem till ett uppslag, där du ska sätta texten snyggt, med rubrik, brödtext och allt som kan behövas. Sedan ska du också välja eller skapa en bild (foto eller illustration) som passar till texten.

Din layout ska i slutet av året användas för att göra ett magasin med alla elevers krönikor.

Projektet bör ta 2-4 veckor .

Arbetsgång

PREPRODUKTION

- ❑ Idégenerering
  - ❑ Läs bland krönikorna och välj en du gillar
  - ❑ Fundera på hur du skulle vilja layouta den och vilken bild som passar till texten
- ❑ Research
  - ❑ Hitta inspiration till layout genom att använda resurserna i slutet på detta dokument
  - ❑ Besök biblioteket och bläddra i några av magasinen där för inspiration
- ❑ Manus eller skiss
  - ❑ Gör en skiss över ett uppslag. Följande saker MÅSTE finnas med
    - ❑ Titel
    - ❑ Brödtext
    - ❑ Bild
    - ❑ Skribentens namn

- ❏ Tidsbokning och planering
    - ❏ Vill du tex fotografera skribenten? Boka isåfall tid med denne.

PRODUKTION

- ❏ Använd Illustrator för att förverkliga din skiss.

POSTPRODUKTION

- ❏ Förbered ditt illustrator-dokument för utskrift
- ❏ Skriv ut och vik
- ❏ Förbered för redovisning med hjälp av powerpointen

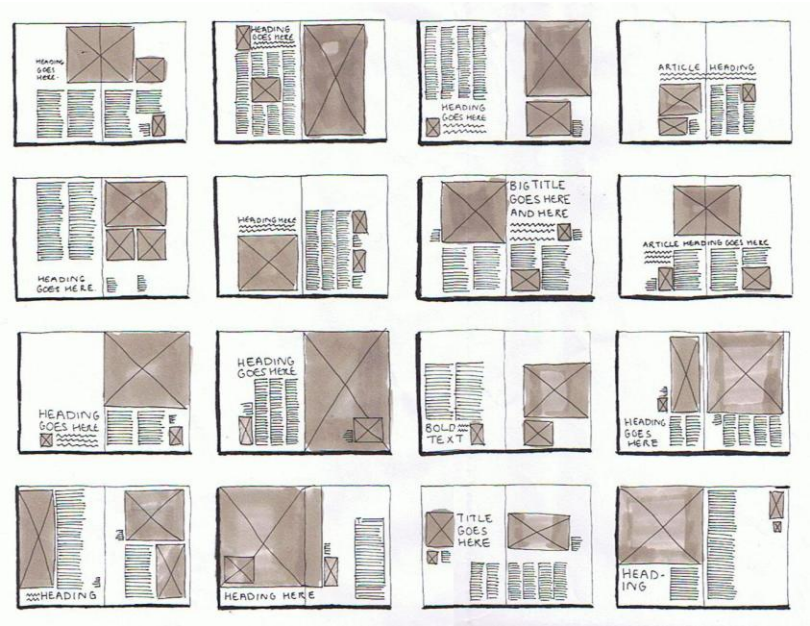
Kravspecifikation

- ❏ 1 st .ai med ditt uppslag
- ❏ 1 st pdf med ditt uppslag
- ❏ 1 st utskrift med ditt uppslag
    - ❏ 1 kopia till skribenten
    - ❏ 1 kopia för inlämning
- ❏ 1 st powerpoint och redovisning

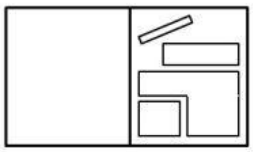
Resurser

[Powerpoint med olika layouter för inspiration]

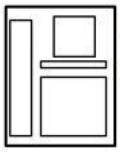
Exempel på layoutskisser:



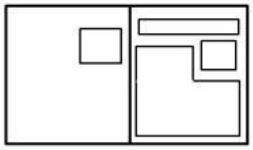
Magazine Layout Ideas



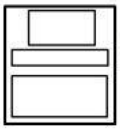
1) Photograph Full Size on the Left Side
2) Top Corner box 'EXCLUSIVE'
3) Box underneath 'Quotation'
4) Middle Box has the interview
5) Bottom Corner Box has another photograph



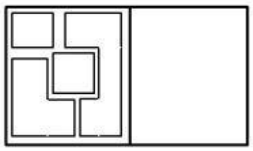
1) Box down the left side 'Contents'
2) Top box has a picture of the feature
3) Quotation in under box
4) Bottom box gives details of other pages



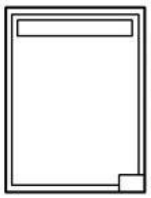
1) Photograph Full Size on the Left Side
2) Box on the left side has a 'Quotation'
3) Top Box on the Right Side has the title
4) Smaller box on Right has another picture
5) Larger Box has the interview



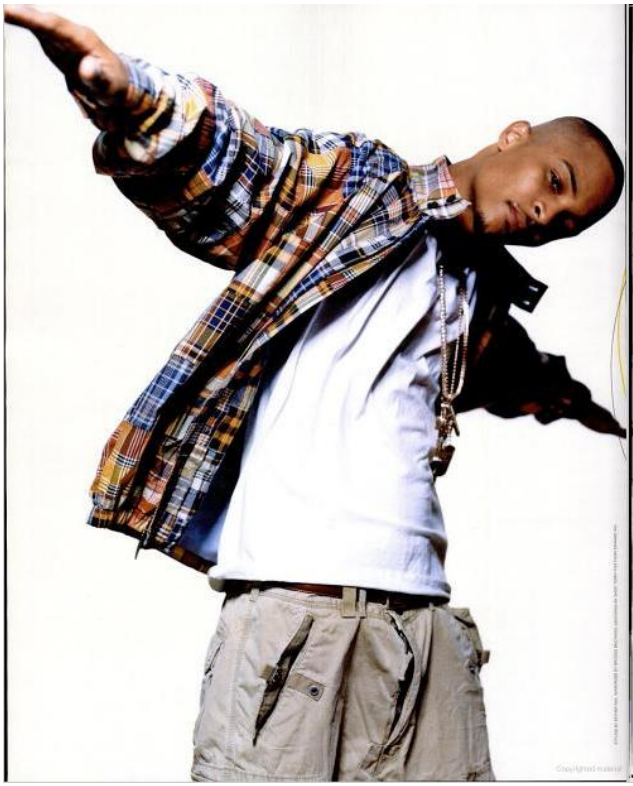
1) Top Box will have the feature
2) Middle Box is 'Contents'
3) Bottom Box gives details of pages



1) Top Left Corner Box will have a photo
2) Middle Box will have a 'Quotation'
3) Bottom Left Box will have Text
4) Biggest box will have text
5) Right side will be a full length photo



1) Picture will be full length
2) Top Middle box will be the masthead
3) Bottom Right Box contains Barcode, Issue, Date etc.
4) Tagline above masthead



The Summer Preview

SUMMER T.I.ME

With Hits Already Emerging From His July Album, T.I. Is Riding A Wave Of Success That Only He Can Stop

By Hillary Crosley

Photograph By Kareem Black

It's just after midnight and T.I. is waiting to go home from Teterboro, N.J.'s Atlantic airport in a private G-3 aircraft, courtesy of producer Wyclef Jean. The plane is equipped with 10 seats, a padded bench and an overeager stewardess tending to Atlanta's favorite rapper and his three friends, who are indulging in a shit-talking game of spades over the cabin's coffee table. ■ "This is when you throw that out," T.I. hollers, pounding the cards on the table. "Two of aces is the fucking high card! Cha'mon!" ■ Playful yelling aside, everyone here knows T.I. well enough to expect that he's going to cheat—it's just a matter of when. Sure enough, after a few hands, T.I. gathers a freshly won mess of cards into his corner and slickly peels the top card back into the fan between his fingers.

C-Rod, longtime friend and Grand Hustle MC, raises a wary eyebrow.

"I seen that, man," he mumbles, sending, cigarette dangling from his lip. "He been doing it all night."

With his eyes still hanging open and his face frozen in his signature T.I. Cheshire bin Laden smirk, C-Rod quickly and fairly deals another hand, and T.I. wins by a landslide. Less than an hour later, after the cocktails, T.I. tries to play his cheating card again.

"I said put it back, man!" C-Rod says with a laugh, and T.I. dutifully, sheepishly, puts the card back into play.

Fun and games are his specialty, but the lighthearted moments may actually speak to a darker side of T.I.—and of Clifford Harris, T.I. himself is showcasing in his upcoming album, "T.I. vs T.I.P.," due July 3. Much of the public knows T.I. as the ultra-suave, super-stylish rapper, the guy who goes to Justin Timberlake videos and makes the ladies swoon. But hip-hop heads and those closest to T.I. know he's a man fighting demons and thus fighting to hold onto his blistering career momentum. That's the essence of T.I.'s new album. He is the pop-star, focused on expanding his horizons and his bottom line. T.I.P.—a childhood nickname shortened to T.I. when the rapper signed his first deal, out of respect to Q-Tip—is the bad boy.

No doubt, life has been good. His last album, "King," featured arguably the song of the year in 2006, "What You Know." The song sat at No. 1 on the Hot R&B/Hip-Hop Songs chart for six weeks and was the theme for the movie of which he starred, "ATL." The album was also the top seller of the year, entering The Billboard 200 at No. 1 and moving 525,000 in first week. It has sold 1.7 million to date, according to Nielsen SoundScan.

Then, in spring, Hip-Hop's wide-ba Grand Hustle label celebrated the release of its first artist, Young Dro, and his song, "Shoulder Lean," emerged as No. 1 hip-hop slot in the country. Live's vice president of urban music, Mark Pitts, reached out to see if T.I. might be interested in working with Timberlake. The pop-star's "My Love" debuting T.I. hit No. 1 on The Billboard Hot 100, hurtling T.I. from hip-hop star to pop success. In the fall, T.I. was nominated for four Grammy Awards and won two for best rap solo performance for "What You Know" and best rap/sung collaboration for "My Love."

His hot streak hasn't stopped. Currently "Top Back," from "King," "Where They At," from his upcoming album, and his feature on R. Kelly's "I'm a Flirt" sit on the Hot R&B/Hip-Hop Songs chart.

But then T.I.P.—friends and label execs refer to him as "Tip" routinely—always seems to be lurking around the corner. In 1997, a pre-rap T.I.P. was arrested, convicted and sentenced to parole for drug charges and giving authorities a false name. Then in 2004, just as his "Rubberband Man" single was proving itself as a hit, T.I. turned himself in for violating parole and served roughly four months in Cobb County jail. Instead of promoting his sophomore album, "Trap Muzik,"

The Gospel According To NICKI MINAJ

Bow down mortals, the newly-crowned Day-Glo queen of hip-hop stands before you. ***Jaimie Hodgson*** *joins the throng and inscribes the* ***10 commandments of our saviour***

PHOTOGRAPH: TOM OXLEY

When Nicki Minaj touched down on British soil for the first time at the end of last month, the scenes that met her at Heathrow resembled a combination of Beatlemania and an Aqua video. In short it was garish pink pandemonium. Three days later, she and her 20-strong entourage were ejected from the well-to-do Dorchester Hotel in Park Lane, London because the staff and guests simply couldn't cope with the relentless hordes of her "Barbs and Ken Barbs" that had decamped outside its regal entrance hall. When you consider we're discussing an artist who as yet is without a UK Top 10 single to her name, there's no denying something very special is afoot.

At a time when it felt like rap music couldn't get any more bland and soulless, and when pop's been strong-arm ed into becoming just another hipster catchphrase, Ms Minaj blessed us with a fantastical new dawn of what both words could mean. After a string of well-placed guest appearances, she brought us hope and light with her 'Pink Friday' album – and a gigantic Day-Glo magenta Lamborghini. With that then, we present to you, our saviour's 10-point plan for a better life.

1 IF THOU IS BORN WITH IT, THOU IS BORN WITH IT

Nicki Minaj: "I think people are **born with star power.** I do think that there is something **inside of people that** when they're born they're ambitious. **I feel like I was** going to win, whatever I have to go **through. I'm not** gonna let up on it," says Ms Minaj.

NME: **Before you'd even released a proper single in the States, you could buy Nicki Minaj magazines at the newsagents.**

"Yeah. *Wind Up!* magazine dedicated a few of their entire magazines to me!"

As an artist who hadn't even released an album, that's pretty insane, isn't it?

"I would say so."

2 THOU SHALT WALK TALL

"Girls tell me this all the time: '**Whenever I feel** like a bad bitch I play your music'. **I want girls to get** confidence listening to me; I want **them to feel like** they don't have to play second fiddle **to a boy. 'Cause** *Jasmine, I'm Aladdin!*' That's the first line of my album. Treat me just like you treat the boys, I'm strong, I'm capable, I'm just like them. I can hold my own, and that's what I want girls to take away. Someone told that to me the other day, 'You're not the underdog anymore, Nicki.' I had to really soak that in, like, 'What? I'm not the underdog anymore?' I have to say, you know what, maybe I'm not the underdog anymore. We have to be able to say that, and own it. Absolutely own it. When girls walk out on the street they need to know that if someone doesn't like them, or doesn't like their face or their body or whatever, it doesn't matter."

3 THOU SHALT KEEP IT CLEAN

"If you listen to my album, compared to my early mixtapes, a lot has changed. I mean, I really toned down the sexual stuff. There was no need for me to do it, I feel like in the past females have kinda relied on that because they feel like that's all they have to offer."

So when you were rapping about lewder stuff, it was because you felt like you should?

"I felt like this is what I was supposed to do. Yeah."

Really?

"Yeah, yeah, I was around people who were telling me, 'This is what you should be doing.' You know, when you're young and impressionable you feel like, 'OK, you know best.' Then you get a little bit older and you're like, 'Hold on, you don't know best and I'm gonna control this thing from now on.'"

4 THOU SHALT BE WHAT THEE SAYETH

"The more people mocked my individualities, the more I wanted to play on them. 'Oh, you don't like my weird voice? I'm gonna do it more and more and I'm gonna show you that you'll love this fucking weird-ass voice! And you're going to learn to love me opening my eyes and pulling my weird-ass faces because I notice, like, ever since I was little, if I know that something annoys you I'm gonna do it more and more.' I wanna get a reaction, I was like that when I was little and it wasn't a great thing because me and my brother, well, my little brother would beat me up all the time because of it!"

5 THOU SHALT NOT GET CAUGHT

"I remember me and my friend, when we were in high school, we always used to steal clothes. I'll always remember the one time we got busted. It's always stuck with me."

Did you get arrested?

"We didn't get taken away by the cops, but we got man-handled and taken away to the basement. We had to give them our names and they were basically like, 'Because you're so young we'll just ban you from the store.' What's crazy is that I'd been, like, going to the mall with my friend for months and never once realising that she'd been stealing clothes. Then when I tried to join in we freaking get busted. It was ridiculous!"

"I REALLY TONED DOWN THE SEXUAL STUFF. THERE WAS NO NEED FOR ME TO DO IT"

6 THOU SHALT REMEMBER WHAT THOU HAST TO LOSE

"People should always think about what they have to lose in life. With me personally I have to always. When I'm confronting people, I think, like, 'Shit, if I do something crazy right now, how am I gonna explain that to my mother?' How am I gonna say that my one crazy moment of anger put me in jail, or took someone's life, how would you explain that? You know, I just try to think long-term, like even if I think right now, 'I wanna hurt this person, I wanna get back at them.' When you think long-term, you realise how small this situation is gonna be in the scale of your life. You have so many freak-ing dreams in your life and you're gonna throw it all away in this one moment of madness."

THE COPY CAT SYNDROME

PLAGIARISM PLAGUES CREATIVE, PROFESSIONAL AND ACADEMIC SPHERES ALIKE

Words: ANUMEHA VERMA

THE ACT OF PLAGIARISM CONSTITUTES MORE OR LESS SIMILAR ACTS WHERE PEOPLE 'KIDNAP' OR 'ABDUCT' THE IDEAS, WORDS, THOUGHTS, LANGUAGE OR EXPRESSIONS OF ANOTHER AUTHOR

It was a short lived fame for Harvard sophomore Kavya Visvanathan. Her book How Opal Mehta Got Kisses, Got Wild and Got a Life, created a wave. The concept of a girl being academically well versed and best at everything yet facing a rejection at her Ivy League University caught the fancy of many, especially students. However, it came as a real dampener for fans when they realized that Kavya was being dogged by accusations of plagiarism and there was some truth in the matter indeed. The book that had brought her to limelight borrowed heavily from two books of Megan Mc Cafferty.

Interestingly, the word Plagiarism is derived from the Latin word Plagiare which means 'to kidnap' or 'abduct.' The act of Plagiarism constitutes more or less similar acts where people 'kidnap' or 'abduct' the ideas, words, thoughts, language or expressions of another author. It is very much like adopting someone else's child and calling it your own in an illegal fashion.

Rather unfortunately, plagiarism is not restricted to just works of fiction and non-fiction. The scholars, authors, lyricists, music composers and artists all over the world have expressed their ire over this uncouth borrowing but solution still remains elusive. While music, painting and performing arts have had their own share of dissolving originality, the academic and journalistic world have been badly hit.

Perhaps the most infamous case in the world of journalism was that of Janet Cooke as early as 1980s. Cooke working with the Washington Post wrote a heart rending account of an eight year old boy Jimmy, a heroin addict. She portrayed Jimmy as a victim of heroin trade flourishing in the poorer neighbourhoods of Washington and the story went on to win a Pulitzer in 1981. However, the story was later discovered to be fake with Cooke accepting that she had never met the boy.

In more recent times, Jayson Blair's case is another one that made several rounds on the news circuit. An American journalist who used to be with the New York Times when the plagiarism charges against him surfaced, he was much respected when the axe befell him. To make matters worse, he was accused of not only lifting the works of other journalists but also of faking sources.

Such cases frequently come to the forefront all over the world including India. It has often been noted that some well established journalists tend to pick up the work of lesser known journalists and project them as their own without any mention of the original work. Half of them the media chooses to ignore, the other half wrench an unwilling apology from perpetrators, not even that sometimes. There are many newspapers that await news flow from different news sources the whole day and simply reproduce them in the evening without any guilt. Everyone knows it is happening and yet we somehow choose to ignore rather than acknowledge. Journalism is fraught with these examples but plagiarism has also caused a serious dent to the academic integrity and respect for other people's works. Academic plagiarism is rampant today across all borders. As a very early experience you start coming around plagiarism even at the school level. Interestingly, entire passages are copied from books and collated to give form to a new book that bears the authorship having no connection with the original work.

THE SCHOLARS, AUTHORS, LYRICISTS, MUSIC COMPOSERS AND ARTISTS ALL OVER THE WORLD HAVE EXPRESSED THEIR IRE OVER THIS UNCOUTH BORROWING BUT SOLUTION STILL REMAINS ELUSIVE.

Going for readymade solutions instead of coming up with something original is the age old way people love to solve any issue. Academics is no different. Right from taking the easy way out by copying chunks of textbooks for assignment to the oversight of mentioning sources used for University Thesis, plagiarism finds a place.

However, it is not just restricted to students looking for an easy way to complete their assignments. Many a times reputed academicians have embarked on the path to plagiarism. It was a shock of gigantic proportions to many when one of the most noted experts of Science Policy, Raghunath Mashelkar revealed that one of his books on intellectual property rights contained text that was plagiarized.

Mashelkar attempted to distance himself by remarking that he had solicited the help of researchers who copied someone else's text and due to lack of time this slipped his attention. Several such cases have time and again also surfaced in different academic circles across the world.

Checks and balances to minimize plagiarism marring the original work of authors and researchers who put in hard work to bring to the world something new is not an easy task. The research papers and books published by reputed publishing houses are checked for plagiarism but existence of sheer number of published books as well as academic research works makes it a rather difficult exercise. Often, the plagiarized text goes unnoticed till the aggrieved owner of the piece comes forward or someone else chances upon it and gets the facts right.

There are softwares in place for checking the practice of plagiarism. Most of these softwares make use of materials stored online. But, not everything ever published is online compounding the problem. In newspapers, strict deadlines adds to pressure lessening the time to check articles for plagiarism. And, in all honesty an editor seldom expects his senior correspondents to submit plagiarized articles until and unless it looks fishy and way out of proportions.

There is a general feeling that plagiarism requires developing a culture where originality of work is appreciated and there is a consensus on citing the sources used honestly. At least professional training in time right from the high school can help prevent accidental plagiarism. Often people , especially in India are acutely unaware of the norms to be used while citing works of another author. It is quite advisable to look into the rules and regulations for citing sources and references before embarking on writing a research paper, book or any other material that is intended to be published. ■

AT HOME IN THE CITY

BY L. CATHERINE HADER

WASHINGTON, DC HAS SUPPORTED ONE of the hottest housing markets in the United States in recent years, with most of the demand being met by condominiums. Unlike the nation's other two hottest markets, South Florida and Las Vegas, which are experiencing record levels of speculative investment buying, demand for condos in DC has soared largely due to job creation and population growth. According to Delta Associates, an Alexandria, Virginia-based real estate advisory firm, in the 12-month period that ended in September 2005, the DC metropolitan area led the nation in job growth, with nearly 80,000 new jobs added to the region's payrolls. The job growth is mirrored in the region's condo purchase statistics: 70 percent of DC-area condominium units sold in 2005 were purchased by resident owners. Developers have responded eagerly to the market demand: Delta estimates that 47,000 units will come onto the local market in the next three years.

Changing lifestyle preferences are also a big factor in the demand for condos. Young professionals, empty nesters, and retirees increasingly are choosing convenience and amenities—proximity to more transit, work, cafés, culture, and entertainment—over the maintenance, yard work, and long commuting time associated with single family homes. A larger market also means that developers can tailor their offerings to specific types of customers, just as automobile manufacturers offer a wide variety of models and styles. Three new signature projects that have recently broken ground exemplify this trend: **The Alta at Thomas Circle**, which is nearing completion for a Fall 2006 opening, and **The Floridian** and **CityVista**, both of which will be completed in 2007. Thoughtfully designed with owners and their communities in mind, they stand to enhance the character and vitality of their neighborhoods.

THE ALTA AT THOMAS CIRCLE

At first glance, this mid-block building at 1333 14th Street, NW, could be mistaken for a sleek new office building; it fits that well among the commercial façades of 14th Street below Thomas Circle. Instead, 126 new residences are tucked behind a sheer glass veil in this new 13-story condominium building designed by Cunningham + Quill Architects PLLC for developers PN Hoffman.

In conceiving The Alta, the developers sought to target a specific subset of the condo market—Washington's young professionals who want to work, live, and play in the same area, at an affordable price. Too often in the DC market, "affordable" can mean an undesirable or remote location, poor design quality, cramped living space, or insufficient parking. For The Alta, Cunningham + Quill and PN Hoffman have given thoughtful consideration to the attributes of a home that this particular segment of the market values most, and have jettisoned conventional notions of "finished space" that drive up costs without adding any meaningful value. The architects have designed compact living spaces: 110 of The Alta's 126 units range from 475 to 995 square feet. These relatively small unit sizes are the key to holding down cost, but their open floor plans, efficient layout, and modern, minimal detailing make the units feel much larger than they are. Expansive window, exposed ductwork, and stone floors impart a contemporary, loft-like character to these single-floor units, while four levels of below-grade parking eliminate one of the principal stresses of urban living for homeowners in this segment of the market.

DEMAND FOR CONDOS IN DC HAS SOARED LARGELY DUE TO JOB CREATION AND POPULATION GROWTH.

While there are many loft-style units available throughout the metropolitan area, there are very few, if any, condominium buildings specifically designed to deliver high-quality design at a reasonable price. No other building on the market is quite like The Alta, but if the brisk pace of sales is any indication, the architects and developers have clearly struck a chord among young buyers. Its success is sure to spark a new "small size, high design" trend in condominium living not unlike the "boutique hotel" trend that has emerged in most major US cities, including DC.

The Alta distinguishes itself not only through design and pricing, but also through sustainable features. Green roofs at the second level terrace and the 13th floor roof provide shelter from UV exposure and reduce runoff into the city's storm water systems. At the same time, they provide green space for the residents to enjoy. Inside, smart design of building systems, extensive use of renewable or recycled materials, as well as "raw" surfaces such as exposed concrete ceilings, further reduce the impact of this building on the environment. The mechanical and electrical systems have been configured and commissioned for maximum efficiency. The majority of the structural system uses concrete mixed with recycled material, and the arrangement of the living units brings maximum daylight into each space, reducing the need for artificial light. PN Hoffman has registered The Alta with the US Green Building Council and hopes to deliver the first LEED-certified condominium to the DC market.

HAT QUIRKY Anheuser-Busch commercial may be simply an oblique way to sell more Bud, but its use of a salutation once confined to the black suburbs of Los Angeles is also a sign that all of America has been conquered by the hip-hop nation. And if nationhood is established by a community of territory, language, culture, economy and historic experience, then the hip-hop nation has truly come of age.

The shared historic experience of the hip-hop nation is rich, complex and storied, replete with triumphs and tragedies; heroes and villains; martyrs and charlatans; trials and tribulations (a lot more trials, actually), and even a civil war that threatened to destroy it. Charting the culture's recent from those heady first days to its dominant place today is the focus of the Brooklyn Museum's ambitious "Hip-Hop Nation: Roots, Rhymes and Rage" exhibit.

Curated by hip-hop journalist Kevin Powell, the show marks the cultural phenomenon's first appearance on this scale in a major museum—on a par with the Met's recent rock 'n' roll exhibit—and it's necessarily, as its curator insists, an introductory tour rather than the last word.

BUT EVEN AS AN INTRODUCTION, it's a breathtaking journey. The exhibit charts the story of hip-hop's evolution from a party-music into a massive music phenomenon, starting when Kurtis Blow, the hip-hop "star" at all the way to Nas, Lauryn Hill and Kanye West. Rapper Chuck D. lists such as Eric B. and Rakim, who "lift the art of rhyming to a new level of profundity, their rap lyrics of gymnastics coming up and smashing the world, while others, such as Public Enemy, use rap music as a platform for social criticism and revival of the nationalist politics of Malcolm X. De La Soul and Tribe Called Quest were among the leaders of an imaginative school of abstract poetics that stretched the envelope of the hip-hop form and sought to connect it with earlier musical traditions such as bebop, but elsewhere 2 Live Crew were appropriating the frenetic Miami drum-and-bass sound to weave lascivious sexual fantasies that got local authorities screaming to shut them down.

Where 2 Live Crew's potty-mouth lyrics may have sparked hip-hop's first sustained confrontation with the law, the rise of gangsta rap opened the floodgates. NWA. (Niggas With Attitude) pioneered the new form with an in-your-face contempt for authority in tales of murder and mayhem set on the streets of Compton, Calif. "F— tha Police" shocked mainstream America, but it resonated with the youth of the hip-hop nation. And it proved frighteningly prophetic when L.A. erupted in riots that shocked the world two years later. NWA. spawned a new breed of rapper, styled as gun-toting hoodlum supposedly giving suburban America a frightening peek into ghetto life—the group knew from pretty early on that about 80 percent of the people buying their albums were white, middle-class kids. Although the industry was happy to cash in, pressure by conservative advocacy groups on major corporations such as Time Warner (parent company of TIME.com) resulted in the industry backing away from promoting gangsta rap. "Hip-Hop Nation" includes original correspondence detailing efforts by Ice-T to be released from his Warner Brothers contract after the corporation had sought to curb certain lyrics.

Gangsta rap, with its narrative tales and its cinematic funk-driven sound, offered a distinct alternative to the tricky bebop gymnastics of the freestyling East Coast. But hip-hop came close to destroying itself in the mid-'90s when that bicoastal rivalry almost turned into a shooting war, as Tupac Shakur—between surviving shootings and spells in prison—threatened the life of Brooklyn rapper the Notorious B.I.G. and both men, former friends, were by the end of 1997 dead in an yet-unsolved drive-by shootings.

But while most hip-hop fans today may be well versed in the tale of Tupac and Biggie, the show transports them back to an era they may find hard to imagine. After all, the almost phasonic fantasy world of a Puffy Combs video is light years away from the hand-stenciled mimeographs with crude sketches advertising an around-the-way appearance of Kurtis Blow or a block party featuring Grandmaster Flash. This was a do-it-yourself movement in the outer boroughs, a culture being built by kids for kids, a culture to which the entertainment industry in the glass towers across the river was mostly impervious for more than a decade.

And for ... exposed to hip-hop as the extent of episodes of death and destruction, "Hip-Hop Nation" offers a glimpse of a time when the culture's roots were in joyous block parties and people having fun. Nas, rapper, is have a good time, show how fun their circumstances. That mood is summed up in the words of rap pioneering DJ Cassidy at a video installation: "If there was no gunfire and fights breaking out at your party, that means your DJ was whack."

IT WAS AT THOSE PARTIES in the "Boogie Down" South Bronx where hip-hop's founding fathers—Kool Herc, Afrika Bambaata and Grandmaster Flash—first began delivering spoken rhymes over the break beats on funk and disco records sometime in the mid-'70s. Today the signature beats-and-rhymes combination of the musical art form they created is as ubiquitous in America's tony suburbs as in its forgotten housing projects, and has kids in distant parts of the world whose first language may be French or Japanese or Wolof chanting choruses inviting their friends to "get at me, dawg."

Hip-hop's language—not simply its slang, which is as likely to be heard in Yale dorm rooms as on inner-city street corners, but its idiom, which involves combining the spoken (or screamed) word with a pastiche of musical elements drawn from previous songs and styles reassembled in new and unique combinations—is not only the preeminent musical genre of a generation, it's also a complex, ever-evolving organism that has spawned countless dialects that are constantly in conversation with one another.

Fig. 1

HAIL TO THE CHIEF

The first President of Hip-Hop: Kanye West

SCHOOL AND RELIGIOUS FAITH

To integrate all faiths

SWITZERLAND, 1993 On 14th March 1991 A. asked the Dietikon School Board to excuse his daughter, M., who at the time was in primary class two, from swimming lessons on religious grounds (the Islamic faith forbids mixed swimming). His request was rejected.

The Swiss Federal Court, however, upheld the father's complaint:

"The dispensation requested by the applicants would not give rise to any substantial additional costs for the school. Nor would it greatly offend the religious feelings of the other pupils. Moreover, such a request is in all respects comparable to the dispensation granted ... to the children of Orthodox Jews or Adventists, who are exempted from manual work or physical exercise or from attending school on the Sabbath. At worst, insurmountable problems might arise if a relatively large proportion of a school's pupils were to request special rules and regulations. To a certain extent it is reasonable to ask teaching staff and the school administration to accede to serious requests by religious minorities, as they do when pupils are absent for other reasons.... Nationals from other countries and cultures residing in Switzerland must, of course, abide by the same rules and regulations as Swiss nationals. There is, however, no legal duty which obliges them to adapt their customs and life-style. The principle of integration does not impose a legal obligation on foreign nationals to restrict their religious or philosophical beliefs to a disproportionate extent."

To show or not to show religious symbols in French schools

FRANCE, 2004 France's National Assembly voted overwhelmingly to adopt a law banning all conspicuous religious symbols from state schools beginning in September. ... Although the measure is officially aimed at maintaining secularism in French schools, Chirac and other leaders have said openly that its main purpose is to ban the Muslim headscarf, seen by many as a symbol of growing fundamentalism. ... The bill says that "in schools, junior high schools and high schools, signs and dress that conspicuously show the religious affiliation of students are forbidden." Although the focus has been on Muslim attire, the law will also ban the wearing of Jewish skullcaps or yarmulkes, as well as Christian crosses. Some of France's schools, mainly in the formerly German eastern provinces, are attached to the Catholic Church and have crucifixes on classroom walls. Opponents of the bill have said that the ban will fail to address the real root of Islamic militancy in France, which is the country's failure to integrate Muslims into French society. Some critics argue that an unintended consequence may be the further polarization of society. ... Those who favor the law have argued that the proliferation of Muslim headscarves in schools runs counter to secularism, which is a principle that has been a source of pride to France since the 1789 revolution. ... Sikhs, who have been in France for generations and many of whom fought for France during World War I, have also become unintended victims of the law. Sikh boys will be forced to make a choice between mandatory education and their religious requirement that their heads be covered with a turban.

Parental rights and religious neutrality of schools

U.N. HUMAN RIGHTS COMMITTEE

The Committee is of the view that Article 18.4 permits public school instruction in subjects such as the general history of religions and ethics if it is given in a neutral and objective way. The liberty of parents or legal guardians to ensure that their children receive a religious and moral education in conformity with their own convictions, set forth in Article 18.4, is related to the guarantees of the freedom to teach a religion or belief stated in Article 18.1. The Committee notes that public education that includes instruction in a particular religion or belief is inconsistent with Article 18.4 unless provision is made for non-discriminatory exemptions or alternatives that would accommodate the wishes of parents and guardians.

Covenant on Civil and Political Rights, 1966

Article 18

4. The States Parties to the present Covenant undertake to have respect for the liberty of parents and, when applicable, legal guardians to ensure the religious and moral education of their children in conformity with their own convictions.

Convention on the Rights of the Child, 1989

Article 14

1. States Parties shall respect the right of the child to freedom of thought, conscience and religion.

2. States Parties shall respect the rights and duties of the parents and, when applicable, legal guardians, to provide direction to the child in the exercise of his or her right in a manner consistent with the evolving capacities of the child.

Children's interests must have priority

The right of parents to give their children a religious education is subject to the principle of the best interest of the child: religious practices which infringe the psychological or physical integrity of the child, for example, female circumcision or refusal to allow a life-saving blood transfusion, are not protected by the right to religious freedom.

FRANCE, Paris, 21 December 2003 A young girl covering her head (scarf) with the French flag and "Liberty, Equality, Fraternity" painted on her face. Around one thousand pupils demonstrate in Paris to protest against the proposed law banning students from wearing religious symbols and other religious insignias in public schools.